

FOURSEVEN DECISIONS

CROSS-SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE CARRIED FORWARD FROM THE v0.4.7 DECISIONS LOG

DOCUMENT PURPOSE

A governed extraction of the v0.4.7 decisions that remain useful after the v0.5 Home and Away redesigns. The document preserves MEDIAN’s attention architecture, shared world-state doctrine, MEET authoring rules, and presentation safeguards while explicitly retiring incompatible 0.4.7 assumptions.

DOCUMENT VERSION	1.0 — initial v0.5 carry-forward pass
GAME-SYSTEM TARGET	MEDIAN v0.5.0
SOURCE BASIS	v0.4.7 Running Decisions; v0.5 Home Loop Rework; v0.5 Away Loop Rework; v0.5 Philosophical Specification
STATUS	Working specification for the structured v0.5 revision document
PRECEDENCE	When this document conflicts with a v0.5 system specification, the newer v0.5 specification leads
SCOPE BOUNDARY	Guest Citizen mechanics and species-specific Guest capability design are deferred to a dedicated v0.5 pass

0. Revision Summary

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VERSION RELATIONSHIP

v0.4.7 explains how MEDIAN pays attention. v0.5 explains what MEDIAN is paying attention to.

1. Purpose, Precedence, and the FourSeven Name

“FourSeven Decisions” is the working name for the cross-system rulings first developed in the v0.4.7 Registers, Views, and Encounter Mode thread and retained after the v0.5 redesign. It is not a revival of v0.4.7 as active canon. It is a controlled salvage operation: keep the architectural decisions that make the new Home and Away specifications cohere; archive the assumptions those specifications have superseded.

The original log was explicitly proposed rather than settled canon. This specification therefore does not preserve entries because they were marked SETTLED inside that log. It re-rules them against the v0.5 architecture.

Precedence order

Priority	Authority	Use
1	v0.5 Philosophical Specification	Defines the game’s governing thesis, Home/Away split, attachment-first base-building purpose, and five-Register architecture.
2	v0.5 Home Loop Rework	Leads all domestic economy, Readiness, Role, Place, Project, Home MEET, Quiet Equilibrium, and EMBODY questions.
3	v0.5 Away Loop Rework	Leads Launch, Crossing, Field, Nodes, Away MEET, Exposure, Return, Stopover, and Homecoming questions.
4	Other dedicated v0.5 specifications	Lead within their subjects, including Embodiment, Ecology, Manifestations, and future Guest Citizen work.
5	This FourSeven Decisions Specification	Provides shared attention, authoring, display, persistence, and world-state doctrine across the above systems.
6	The v0.4.7 Running Decisions log	Historical source and rationale only.

REVISION MANDATE

No 0.4.7 rule survives merely by silence. Contradictory assumptions are named as superseded rather than quietly inherited.

2. Executive Summary and Canonical System Statement

The v0.5 redesign gives MEDIAN two highly developed halves: DWELL makes sanctuary mechanically achievable at Colony scale, while TRAVEL / RISK / MEET expose particular Citizens to distance and consequence. The FourSeven decisions provide the connective tissue that makes those halves feel like one game.

What this specification governs

- When continuous Register play remains continuous and when the game fixes attention through MEET.
- How one authored situation can manifest differently in Home and Away contexts without becoming two systems.
- How named Citizens, Roles, Places, and whole-colony facts are selected for foreground representation.
- How unresolved Home situations persist without becoming an entropy treadmill or task inbox.
- How world facts remain singular while producing different consequences in DWELL, TRAVEL, RISK, MEET, and EMBODY.
- How personal lives remain descriptive and legible without citizen stat bars, morale meters, or ornamental gauges.
- How environmental pressure is staged over time and how visual backdrops preserve spatial continuity.

Canonical system statement

MEDIAN remains continuous and observable until a situation becomes bounded, consequential, and worthy of direct attention. MEET fixes that attention. The resulting choice acts upon one shared world state, then returns the player to a Register whose ordinary life visibly incorporates what occurred.

3. Register and View Architecture

3.1 Register definition

A Register is MEDIAN’s complete visual and interactive contract for one kind of player attention. It governs framing, scale, time treatment, navigation, available controls, information hierarchy, Citizen representation, and the class of decision being asked for. A Register is not a geographic zone.

Register	Verb	Primary attention
DWELL	Dwell	Sustain and observe collective life at Home.
TRAVEL	Travel	Read territory, route, distance, load, shelter, and changing conditions Away.
RISK	Risk	Act inside immediate embodied danger, especially Crossing.
MEET	Meet	Attend to a bounded circumstance and decide how the relevant subject responds.
EMBODY	Embody	Experience a Citizen’s lived scale within the safety of Home.

3.2 View definition

A View is a specific presentation built inside a Register. Views allow MEDIAN to create categorically different scenes without inventing a new mode for every presentation need.

Register	Example Views
DWELL	Colony Overview View; Role and Readiness View; Project View; Place inspection.
TRAVEL	Home Reach View; Margin View; longitudinal Reach View; Stopover approach.
RISK	Staging View; outbound Crossing View; return Crossing View.

Register	Example Views
MEET	Heavy Winds View; Base Defense View; Launch View; Homecoming View; contested Node View; uncontested resource View.
EMBODY	Practice View; Presence View; species-specific Flow, Rest, Tend, or relationship moments.

3.3 Register change test

The Register changes because the player’s relationship to a place changes, not because the map location changed.

A berry bush is navigable geography in TRAVEL. It becomes MEET when a party decides what relationship to establish with it or when another Presence contests it. A Rabbit court is part of DWELL until Heavy Winds make its exposed shelter line a bounded decision. The same court may later become an EMBODY Presence scene once Quiet Equilibrium returns.

3.4 Anti-fragmentation rule

New presentation needs should first be tested as Views inside an existing Register. A new Register is justified only when the player’s complete relation to time, scale, control, and subject changes. This rule did not prevent EMBODY; it explains why EMBODY qualified while Launch, Homecoming, Base Defense, and Road Work did not.

4. The Attention Threshold: Native Information and MEET

4.1 Native information rule

Routine facts remain in the Register that produced them. A pantry total changing, a Project completing, rain beginning, a Readiness Margin narrowing, or a Reach becoming slower does not by itself justify a modal scene.

4.2 MEET threshold

A situation earns MEET when enough of the following are present:

- a genuine choice
- named or socially meaningful participation
- competing needs
- uncertain or costly outcome
- opportunity or danger
- persistent consequence
- a reason to stop surveying and attend

Information remains native. Consequential interaction becomes MEET.

4.3 Why restraint matters

The fixed MEET presentation is itself a promise: this moment deserves attention and may be remembered. If every small change seizes the camera, MEET loses dramatic weight and DWELL becomes an alarm dashboard. The threshold therefore protects both attachment-first play and successful stillness.

4.4 Chosen attention and arriving attention

Origin Register	The player goes to it	It comes to the player
DWELL	The player attends an open Place, Project, or known situation whose resolution requires MEET.	A Colony situation reaches the threshold and calls attention.
TRAVEL	The party enters a Node or deliberately approaches a known Presence.	A Field card or environmental interruption finds the party.
RISK	Not normally applicable; the Register is already direct embodied action.	Not normally applicable.

Origin Register	The player goes to it	It comes to the player
EMBODY	No consequential MEET is nested inside an EMBODY experience.	An urgent crisis ends eligibility or closes the experience rather than ambushing it with a decision modal.

The Field cadence guardrail remains: Nodes are the meal; cards are the weather. When interruptions become the principal content of travel, territory has stopped being readable.

5. Choice Events and Persistent Situations

5.1 Choice Event as content packet

The Choice Event is the authored content object. MEET is the runtime manifestation. The packet must be complete enough to appear in the correct View without depending on a literal card overlay.

Packet field	Required content
Trigger	World-state, calendar, pressure, route, Place, Node, relationship, or authored campaign condition.
Origin	DWELL, TRAVEL, or a connector such as Launch / Homecoming.
Situation family	Environmental pressure, social claim, resource opportunity, Base Defense, arrival, personal incident, return, and so on.
Scene requirements	Location, backdrop, time, weather, season, active objects, and affected Places or Nodes.
Subject	Colony, Role, household, personal Citizen, or expedition party.
Stakes	Primary stake, secondary stake, threatened value, and what changes if the player refuses.
Response grammar	Home MEET choice frame, uncontested Node grammar, contested Away Approaches, Launch, Homecoming, or another approved View grammar.
Costs and requirements	Resources, Citizen-Days, equipment, relationships, time, load, or role posture.
Consequences	Group outcome, personal consequence where applicable, duration, escalation, Conditions, route or Place changes.
Memory	Campaign Memory / Chronicle language and later retrieval hooks.

5.2 Canonical lifecycle

TRIGGER → SITUATION OPENS → MEET VIEW → RESPONSE → CONSEQUENCE → WORLD-STATE CHANGE → MEMORY

5.3 A bounded scene is not always an instant resolution

Home-origin situations may remain physically present after their first MEET View. A flooded pantry may reveal a restoration cost the Colony cannot yet meet. A damaged route may remain closed. A displaced household may continue occupying temporary space. The situation remains a scene with a known subject and state; it does not become a free-floating quest marker.

Situation phase	Home-origin meaning
Open	The problem becomes known and is visibly located in the Colony.
Remain open	The player defers, lacks the required commitment, or chooses to tolerate the present state.
Escalate or change	Elapsed time, season, or another event alters cost, scope, or affected Places.
Close	Action, deliberate inaction, or expiration resolves the situation.
Remember	Significant outcomes enter Campaign Memory.

5.4 Persistence guardrail

Persistent Home situations must remain uncommon, local, and legible. They are not a replacement for continuous decay, a daily chore list, or a backlog of unresolved errands. Most competent domestic posture should continue to produce silent success.

Away situations generally cannot be parked and resumed at leisure. The party is physically present, time is passing, and refusal or withdrawal is itself a resolution.

6. Participant Scale and Relational Scene Composition

6.1 The subject determines representation

MEET scale	Crunch subject	Foreground representation
Whole Colony	Global Capacity, Load, materials, threatened Places, and time.	Colony-state strip; no arbitrary fixed portrait lineup.
Standing Role	One entrusted civic responsibility and its global capacity.	Relevant Role-holder or adviser when the fiction benefits from a named voice.
Household / work group	A bounded set of Citizens sharing a Place, Practice, or immediate stake.	Only those affected.
Personal incident	A particular Citizen is trapped, injured, responsible, uniquely committed, or personally addressed.	Full named Citizen treatment.
Away party	The exact Citizens who chose to leave and whose individual state governs options and consequence.	Every expedition participant.

Named Citizens appear because the situation makes them relevant, not because the interface requires a fixed party lineup.

6.2 Relational, not adversarial

A MEET composition partitions the elements brought into consequential relationship. It does not imply combat or even opposition.

Side A	Relation	Side B
Colony	must answer	Heavy Winds
Available labor	must be committed against	A threatened pantry
Returning expedition	must be received by	The Colony
Party	must establish a relationship with	An uncontested wildflower field
Party	must negotiate with	A recurring animal Presence
Rabbit court	must endure or redirect	Road Work pressure

6.3 Advisor voice

A named adviser may interpret the threatened value in the language of the Colony without revealing exact success odds. This creates character exposure inside Colony-scale play while preserving the Colony as the mechanical subject.

EXAMPLE ADVISER LINE

“Brace the ladders first. A fall from the upper reach could cost more than timber.”

7. One World State Across Five Registers

7.1 Canonical doctrine

Important facts belong to world state, not to a Register. A Register displays or acts upon those facts; it never creates a parallel version of them.

MEDIAN maintains one Citizen Record, one wound, one relationship, one Tool, one cargo state, one route, one Place condition, one Promise, and one Campaign Memory. The five Registers expose different consequences of those same facts.

World fact	DWELL	TRAVEL	RISK	MEET	EMBODY
Injured leg	Reduces Role availability or creates Care Load.	Slows pace and narrows route options.	Makes timing and recovery harder.	Changes available responses and personal consequence.	May shape a guided recovery Presence scene once safety exists.
Critical cargo	Enters shared stores or a Project.	Consumes carrying capacity and changes return burden.	Makes a Crossing harder to commit through.	May be protected, traded, yielded, or lost.	May later appear as a familiar Place object or remembered detail.
Trusted Friend	Influences domestic presence and later memory.	Changes willingness to travel or press onward.	Shapes who returns for whom.	Opens relational choices and consequences.	Supports social Presence or Practice moments.
Damaged Place	Creates Load, shortfall, or a Project need.	May alter the route through Home Reach.	May affect a Staging edge.	Becomes a bounded repair or protection situation.	Blocks or changes experiences rooted in that Place.

7.2 Feature test

For every proposed mechanic, ask: “Is this a new system, or a new situation produced by existing systems in another Register?” A separate surgery game, morale economy, or Homecoming inventory subsystem is presumptively wrong when wounds, Care, supplies, and allocation already exist as shared facts.

8. Personal Information and Numerical Restraint

8.1 Shared logistics may be numerical

Colony-scale facts such as Citizen count, Capacity, Load, Margin, stored resources, Citizen-Days, threatened Places, and Project progress may be expressed numerically because they are public shared logistics.

8.2 Individual lives remain descriptive

Citizen condition is shown through named Conditions, descriptive bands, behavior, posture, animation, equipment, injury, and history. The interface does not reduce a Citizen to exposed health numbers or a second morale bar.

Allowed personal information	Rejected substitute
Healthy; Hurt; Maimed; recovering; unable to take a Role	32 / 32 Health
Shaken; grief; fear of a trigger; tharn	Spirit meter
Trusted Friend; estranged; protective; dependent	Relationship score
Named wound and lasting impairment	Generic damage points
Exposure state and widening consequence distribution	A universal “danger bar” that duplicates other systems

8.3 New meter burden of proof

Every proposed group meter must be classified as either persistent state or a descriptive readout of existing state. Decorative quantities such as Party Unity, Community Resolve, Party Alarm, Party Calm, Negotiation Posture, or Harvest Outlook do not become new tracks merely because a prototype has room for them.

Use numbers for shared logistics. Use language and visible condition for individual lives.

9. DWELL Attention States: Open and Called

9.1 Open DWELL

Open is the ordinary domestic condition. The player may build, assign, observe, read, rearrange, inspect, linger, or enter EMBODY when eligible. Routine state does not seize the camera. A well-running Colony can remain here for meaningful stretches.

9.2 Called DWELL

Called is the moment a Colony situation crosses the MEET threshold. Attention fixes on a bounded scene until the player responds, deliberately leaves the situation open, or accepts its consequence. Called is not a queue state; it is a specific event state.

Open	Called
The player chooses where to look.	A specific circumstance has become too consequential to remain ambient.
The Colony is legible as a continuous inhabited whole.	The camera and information hierarchy isolate the subject and stakes.
Projects, stores, Roles, Places, and Citizens progress without modal interruption.	The player makes or defers a bounded decision.
EMBODY may be available under Quiet Equilibrium.	EMBODY is unavailable until the acute situation is resolved or safely deferred.

In TRAVEL, the player moves freely until they reach something. In DWELL, the player lives freely until something reaches them.

9.3 Off-screen protection

The attachment-first contract remains: MEDIAN does not take a named animal from the player off-screen. While attention is Away, Home may progress, improvise, gain something, or suffer inconvenience. A dangerous Home situation may open and wait. It may become more expensive or constrain more Places, but personal catastrophe is not resolved unseen.

v0.5 correction: Home outcome depends on remaining Role headcount, Places, spatial alignment, stores, and Readiness—not on hidden differences in individual worker aptitude.

10. Event Time: Telegraph, Impact, Persistence, and Aftermath

Environmental events become clearer when written as phases rather than as one card that simultaneously warns, strikes, and repairs itself.

Phase	System meaning	Typical presentation
Telegraph	The world becomes legible before the full event. Preparation may still alter what will be at stake.	Ambient signs in DWELL or TRAVEL; a Called Home MEET when a real preparatory choice exists.
Impact / Onset	The pressure actually strikes. Prior posture, Readiness, preparation, and unavoidable immediate action resolve.	Brief adjudication, animation, or direct RISK where appropriate; not a leisurely menu pretending time has stopped.
Persistence	The event continues, shifts, or creates a second bounded decision.	Home MEET, Away MEET, changed route terms, sustained Load, or a threatened Place.

Phase	System meaning	Typical presentation
Aftermath	What remains after the immediate pressure: damage, displacement, care, cleanup, memory, changed routes.	Condition, Project, open Home situation, Homecoming consequence, or Campaign Memory.

10.1 Phase integrity rule

If the player is offered a considered choice, the event has not fully struck yet, or it is still running. The blow itself is never disguised as a leisurely planning screen.

10.2 Example: Heavy Winds

Telegraph	Impact	Persistence	Aftermath
Reeds bend; lines hum; a Watchkeeper identifies the upper reach as vulnerable.	Unsecured coverings tear according to existing Builder / Watch posture.	The player spends one of two different commitments to preserve different stakes, or refuses and accepts the compounded result.	Upper rooms close; a repair Project opens; a Citizen may need care; later EMBODY scenes reflect the changed Place.

11. Base Defense and Home-Origin MEET

Base Defense remains a Home-origin MEET family, not a separate tactical combat system. The Colony is the party. Its defense is expressed through prepared Places, species spatial grammar, Role Capacity, relevant weakness, materials, and the willingness to accept loss.

11.1 Canonical Home MEET grammar

Option	Function
Protect the primary stake	Spend one appropriate commitment to preserve the most important threatened value.
Protect or redirect the secondary stake	Spend a different commitment to save, move, or transform another threatened value.
Commit neither	Preserve scarce capacity now and accept the compounded consequence.

This grammar supersedes the old attempt to apply the five contested Away Approaches to storms, floods, structural failures, and Base Defense.

11.2 Personal consequence at Home

A Home MEET may become personal when the fiction genuinely places a Citizen in danger. It may produce injury, fear memory, displacement, grief, or death. It does not ordinarily become a second Citizen-growth engine.

Outcome	v0.5 ruling
Domestic courage	May enter Campaign Memory, a Tale, later dialogue, or an EMBODY scene.
Maiming / fear memory	Possible when a particular Citizen is genuinely exposed in a severe Home event.
Distinction / After-name	Primarily belongs to individually resolved Away responsibility. Domestic exceptions require authored story justification rather than routine mechanical access.

12. Spatial Fidelity and Encounter Backdrops

12.1 Known-place doctrine

A MEET backdrop is a consequential rendering of a Place already established in DWELL or TRAVEL. It preserves the player’s mental map while changing framing, time, weather, inhabitants, and state.

Origin	MEET rendering
Rabbit court in DWELL	The same court under wind pressure, with threatened roofline and covered exits labeled in the scene.
Wildflower Node in TRAVEL	The same field as an uncontested resource choice or contested claim.
Home edge / Staging ground	Launch and Homecoming share a legible axis and opposite emotional direction.
Held Reach shelter	A Stopover, request for aid, or outpost consequence uses the same established shelter footprint.

12.2 Backdrop economy

This doctrine is both spatial canon and production discipline. Registers should feel categorically different without each becoming a feature-complete standalone genre. Re-lighting and re-populating known places allows MEET to be visually rich without creating disconnected scene geography.

12.3 Strategic transparency

Colony art remains operationally legible even where roofs, walls, brush, or foliage would conceal the world diegetically. “Open to the player” is not “open to the world.” Spatial fidelity concerns the implied Place and its relationships, not literal camera occlusion.

13. Authoring and Presentation Doctrine

13.1 Environmental labels belong in the scene

Functional labels such as Exposed Roofline, Open Grass, Loose Coverings, or Swaying Ladder should point into the rendered Place. They describe terrain and stakes without creating a tactical positioning grid.

13.2 Terrain changes price, not menu

Away terrain may change the difficulty, consequence, or Exposure associated with an Approach. It does not create citizen-by-citizen positioning, facing, initiative, or targeting. The party remains one body on the front end; individuality resolves on the back end.

13.3 Canonical examples use canonical people

Worked examples, concept plates, and system vignettes must draw from approved colony and Citizen banks. Reusing one name for different Citizens, inventing an unapproved roster for convenience, or allowing a concept image to establish new canon causes avoidable drift.

13.4 Visual invention does not establish canon

Concept art may explore composition, material culture, weather, and mood. New Places, species, objects, structures, and mechanics become canon only through approved design text and designated reference plates.

13.5 Situation-state prototype requirement

A MEET chassis is not proven by entry-choice screens alone. Before large-scale authoring, representative situations should be demonstrated across their full state sequence:

- Approach or Home-choice state
- Turn or persistence state
- personal consequence or thorn interrupt where applicable
- aftermath / open situation state
- return to native Register with changed world state

14. v0.5 Revisions to Specific FourSeven Rulings

14.1 Ambient warning and Guest boundary

The old log’s useful insight is retained at a high level: warnings should emerge through living behavior and environmental change rather than abstract countdown timers. A recurring resident may refuse to settle; a ground-dwelling neighbor may appear on high ground; a familiar animal may behave at the wrong hour.

The old hard economy of four Guest slots divided into “warning” and “capability” modules is not carried forward here. Guest Citizen identity, residence, limits, relationships, and mechanical contribution require the dedicated v0.5 Guest Citizen pass. This specification preserves only the diegetic-warning principle.

14.2 Outpost identity after the Away rework

The old ruling that a Held Reach carries partial Home Mode is superseded. An outpost remains Away: a refuge, Stopover, low Care point, Watch point, cache, and place to end a leg. It does not support DWELL or EMBODY as an alternate Colony.

An outpost gives you the roof. It never gives you the village.

The older emotional and species observations remain useful as worldbuilding: Mouse experiences a room that touches nothing; Rabbit experiences frontage without Company; Squirrel experiences a node with insufficient redundancy. These shape scenes and fears, not a second domestic ruleset.

14.3 Multi-day focus switching

The old “leg is the unit of Away focus” proposal remains unresolved under v0.5. A multi-day journey may need to cut back to Dawn at Home while the party rests at a Stopover, but the exact player authority, EMBODY eligibility, and treatment of continuing absence are not yet canonical. This belongs to the Corridor and Frontier Progression pass.

14.4 Corridor narrative orientation

The qualitative campaign geography survives strongly: down-corridor leads toward the ruined ancestral home and the weight of the past; up-corridor leads toward the Rest-Stop Metropolis and a possible civic future. The corridor continues beyond both.

A colony can go back and look at what it lost before it can reach what it might become.

Exact numbers of Reaches, Reaches per day, and required outposts remain prototype values, not fixed canon.

14.5 No generic expedition Rating

The old unresolved question of whether every Encounter receives a Legendary / Successful / Hard-Earned / Failed grade is closed by the Away rework: there is no generic expedition grade. Memory should preserve what was achieved, paid, changed, and carried home rather than flattening the journey into one score.

15. Supersession Ledger

v0.4.7 assumption	v0.5 disposition	Leading replacement
Four Registers only	Superseded	Five Registers including EMBODY.
Encounter verb becomes Interact	Superseded	MEET, understood as consequential relationship rather than person-to-person contact.
Field verb becomes Explore	Not adopted	TRAVEL remains the broader and more accurate verb.
Launch / Homecoming exist to preserve a four-Register ceiling	Reframed	They remain MEET Views because their subject is a bounded relational decision, not because a fifth Register is forbidden.
Five Approaches as universal Encounter UI	Superseded for Home	Home MEET uses the Colony three-choice grammar; five Approaches remain provisional for contested Away MEET.
Road Work Onset may use a full choice strip	Superseded	Telegraph and Persistence may use MEET; Impact resolves prior posture and immediate consequence.

v0.4.7 assumption	v0.5 disposition	Leading replacement
Crossing has no Exposure	Superseded	Crossing may produce personal Exposure without using the MEET Exposure procedure.
Exposure only in contested MEET	Superseded	Exposure may arise through TRAVEL, RISK, and MEET.
Individual Home aptitude affects outcome	Superseded	Equal Citizen contribution to global Roles; fiction may credit named action without hidden productivity modifiers.
Held Reach supports reduced Colony Register	Superseded	Held Reach supports Away refuge and Stopover functions only.
Home is a portable state	Superseded	Full sanctuary is produced by the Colony; calm Away is not Home.
Fixed 70 / 20 / 10 return crossing	Superseded	Return Burden and context determine whether return Crossing is played, compressed, or elided.
Expedition Rating summarizes the run	Superseded	Homecoming and Campaign Memory preserve achievement, cost, changes, and absences.
Domestic rework deferred to v0.5	Completed in principle	Places, Practices, Roles, Projects, Readiness, Weakness ledger, Home MEET, Quiet Equilibrium.

16. Deferred Systems and Open Questions

16.1 Core MEET implementation questions

- Complete Away MEET Turn presentation, including a tharn state that clearly asks who goes back and what is abandoned.
- Limits on the number, duration, and escalation of simultaneously open Home situations.
- Whether terrain alters Presence, consequence, or Exposure in contested Away MEET, and how that remains legible without positioning.
- How Home MEET persistence and the Dawn adjudication interact when a situation remains unresolved.

16.2 Citizen History and Campaign Memory

- Formal scope of Distinctions, After-names, Keepsakes, fear memories, Tales, and memorial record under the Home/Away growth split.
- What replaces summary Ratings while still giving the Chronicle a compact derived account of an expedition.
- How EMBODY retrieves, expresses, or quietly leaves ephemeral prior events.

16.3 Corridor and Frontier Progression

- Multi-day focus switching between a resting Away party and the Colony.
- Reaches per day, outpost chain length, and the pacing of ancestral-home and Metropolis journeys.
- Folk names and cultural meanings for up-corridor and down-corridor directions.
- How mature Squirrel networks avoid reducing Home to merely one node among many.

16.4 Guest Citizen system boundary

Guest Citizens, ambient residents, recurring visitors, warning behavior, residence limits, social integration, and capability design are deliberately deferred. The future Guest specification must mesh with Roles, Places, Home Readiness, Away parties, Campaign Memory, and EMBODY without turning non-core species into slotted infrastructure modules.

17. Canon Rules, Non-Goals, and Acceptance Tests

17.1 Canon rules

- A Register is a mode of attention; a View is a presentation within it.
- Routine information remains native; bounded consequential interaction becomes MEET.
- Choice Events are authored packets whose consequences change one shared world state.
- Home-origin situations may remain open, but persistence is rare, local, and never a substitute for continuous decay pressure.
- Participant representation follows the actual subject of the situation.
- MEET is relational rather than inherently adversarial.
- Personal lives are expressed through descriptive condition and history; shared logistics may be numerical.

- DWELL is Open by default and Called only by threshold-worthy situations.
- Environmental events distinguish Telegraph, Impact, Persistence, and Aftermath.
- Base Defense remains Home MEET, not a second combat game.
- MEET backdrops preserve the geography of known Places and Nodes.
- Concept art does not establish new canon without approved design text.

17.2 Non-goals

- A fifth economic subsystem for every View or Register.
- Modal interruption as the normal texture of domestic play.
- A generic event deck that makes the Colony feel like a place things only happen to.
- Tactical positioning, initiative, facing, or targeting inside MEET.
- Citizen health numbers, Spirit bars, or decorative group meters.
- Using named Citizens as interface furniture when the Colony is the actual subject.
- Portable Home Mode at outposts or calm Away locations.
- Guest species treated as four-slot warning and capability modules before their dedicated design pass.

17.3 Acceptance tests

Test	Pass condition
Attention test	A player can distinguish ambient information from a true MEET without relying only on labels.
Stillness test	A competent Colony can remain in Open DWELL without continuous forced events.
Subject test	A whole-Colony event does not display arbitrary expedition portraits, and a personal event does not dissolve the Citizen into a generic capacity number.
Persistence test	An unresolved Home situation remains visible and meaningful without creating an ever-growing task backlog.
World-state test	The same wound, relationship, cargo object, Place condition, and route remain consistent across every Register.
Numerical-restraint test	No Citizen screen exposes health numerals, Spirit, or redundant personal meters.
Temporal test	The player can tell whether an environmental event is being telegraphed, striking, persisting, or leaving aftermath.
Backdrop test	A MEET scene remains recognizably the same Place or Node the player knew before attention fixed upon it.
Attachment test	The interface makes the player attend to threatened lives and Places without converting them into replaceable production assets.
Guest-boundary test	The document's rules remain valid without deciding detailed Guest species capabilities.

Final System Statement

The FourSeven Decisions are the shared grammar by which MEDIAN changes scale without changing reality. DWELL, TRAVEL, RISK, MEET, and EMBODY do not own separate versions of the world. They are five ways of attending to the same Colony, corridor, Citizens, Places, injuries, promises, and memories.

The practical sequence is simple: ordinary Registers reveal the world; threshold-worthy circumstances call MEET; MEET fixes attention on the appropriate subject; consequences alter shared world state; the player returns to ordinary life and sees what changed. This architecture lets Home remain lingerable, Away remain consequential, and attachment remain the reason the systems matter.

END OF SPECIFICATION